



LEVEL 1

Your survey report

Property address

Client's name

Inspection Date

Surveyor's RICS number

1

Contents

A	About the inspection and report
B	Summary of condition ratings
C	About the property
D	Outside the property
E	Inside the property
F	Services
G	Grounds
H	Issues for your legal advisers
I	Risks
J	Surveyor's declaration
K	What to do now
L	Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 1 service and terms of engagement
M	Typical house diagram
	RICS disclaimer

A

About the inspection and report

This RICS Home Survey – Level 1 has been produced by a surveyor, who has written this report for you to use. If you decide not to act on the advice in this report, you do so at your own risk.

A

About the inspection and report

As agreed, this report will contain the following:

- a physical inspection of the property (see 'The inspection' in section L) and
- a report based on the inspection (see 'The report' in section L).

About the report

We aim to give you professional advice about:

- the construction and general condition of the property on the date it was inspected;
- any defects that need urgent attention or are serious;
- things that need further investigation to prevent serious damage to the fabric of the building; and
- serious defects or issues that may be hazardous to safety and where further enquiries are needed.

Any extra services we provide are not covered by these terms and conditions, and must be covered by a separate contract.

About the inspection

- We only carry out a visual inspection.
- We inspect roofs, chimneys and other surfaces on the outside of the building from ground level and, if necessary, from neighbouring public property and with the help of binoculars.
- We will visually inspect the parts of the roof structure and other features that can be seen from the access hatch. We will not remove secured access panels and/or lift insulation material, stored goods or other contents.
- We will inspect the surfaces of exposed floors and under-floor spaces so far as there is safe access to these, but we will not lift carpets, floor coverings, floorboards or move furniture. We will assess floors for excessive deflection by a 'heel-drop' test. We are not able to assess the condition of the inside of any chimney, boiler or other flues. Also, we do not remove secured panels or undo electrical fittings.
- We note in our report if we are not able to check any parts of the property that the inspection would normally cover. If we are concerned about these parts, the report will tell you about any further investigations that are needed.
- We do not report on the cost of any work to put right defects or make recommendations on how these repairs should be carried out. Some maintenance and repairs we suggest may be expensive.
- We inspect the inside and outside of the main building and all permanent outbuildings, but we do not force or open up the fabric of the building. We also inspect parts of the electricity, gas/oil, water heating and drainage services that can be seen, but we do not test them.
- To help describe the condition of the home, we give condition ratings to the main parts (the 'elements') of the building, garage and some parts outside. Some elements can be made up of several different parts.
- In the element boxes in sections C, D, E and F, we describe the part that has the worst condition rating first and then briefly outline the condition of the other parts.

 Reminder

A

About the inspection

Surveyor's name

Surveyor's RICS number

Company name

Date of the inspection

Report reference number

Related party disclosure

Full address and postcode of the property

Weather conditions when the inspection took place

Status of the property when the inspection took place

B

Summary of condition ratings

This section summarises the condition ratings of the different elements of the property.

If an element is made up of a number of different parts (for example, a pitched roof to the main building and a flat roof to an extension), only the part in the worst condition is shown here.

Important note

To get a balanced impression of the property, we strongly recommend that you read all sections of the report, in particular section K, 'What to do now', and discuss this with us if required.

B

Condition ratings

To determine the condition of the property, we assess the main parts (the 'elements') of the building, garage and some outside areas. These elements are rated on the urgency of maintenance needed, ranging from 'very urgent' to 'no issues recorded'.



Documents we may suggest you request before you sign contracts

There are documents associated with the following elements. Check these documents have been supplied by your solicitor before exchanging contracts.

Element no.	Document name	Received
F1 Electricity	Electrical Installation Condition Report	
F2 Gas/Oil	Home Owner Gas Safety Record	



Elements that require urgent attention

These elements have defects that are serious and/or need to be repaired, replaced or investigated urgently. Failure to do so could risk serious safety issues or severe long-term damage to your property.

Element no.	Element name
E6	Built-in fittings (built-in kitchen and other fittings, not including appliances)
F1	Electricity
F2	Gas/oil
F4	Heating
F5	Water heating



Elements that require attention but are not serious or urgent

These elements have defects that need repairing or replacing, but are not considered to be either serious or urgent. These elements must also be maintained in the normal way.

Element no.	Element name
D4	Main walls
D5	Windows



Elements with no current issues

No repair is currently needed. The elements listed here must be maintained in the normal way.

Element no.	Element name
D2	Roof coverings
D3	Rainwater pipes and gutters
D6	Outside doors (including patio doors)
D8	Other joinery and finishes
E1	Roof structure
E2	Ceilings
E3	Walls and partitions
E4	Floors
E7	Woodwork (e.g. staircase and joinery)
E8	Bathroom fittings
F3	Water



Elements not inspected

We carry out a visual inspection, so a number of elements may not have been inspected. These are listed here.

Element no.	Element name
F6	Drainage

C

About the property

This section includes:

- About the property
- Energy efficiency

C

About the property

Type of property

Approximate year the property was built

Approximate year the property was extended

Approximate year the property was converted

Information relevant to flats and maisonettes

Construction

Accommodation

	Living rooms	Bedrooms	Bath or shower	Separate toilet	Kitchen	Utility room	Conservatory	Other
Ground	1	0	0	1	1	0	0	0
First	0	2	1	0	0	0	0	0

C

Energy efficiency

We are advised that the property's current energy performance, as recorded in the EPC, is as stated below:

Energy Efficiency Rating

Mains services

A marked box shows that the relevant mains service is present.

☒

Gas

☒

Electric

☒

Water

☒

Drainage

Central heating

☒

Gas

☐

Electric

☐

Solid fuel

☐

Oil

☐

None

Other services or energy sources (including feed-in tariffs)

D

Outside the property

D

Full detail of elements inspected

Limitations on the inspection

The external inspection of the building was limited to those parts that could be seen from ground level, within the boundaries of the property and from accessible public areas only.

A random sample test of windows was undertaken.

As it was dry at the time of the inspection, I am unable to confirm if the rainwater fittings are fully effective and watertight.

There may be hidden defects in the areas I could not inspect. The condition ratings assigned throughout this report are based on what was visible to me at the time of inspection.



D1 Chimney stacks

There are no chimney stacks at the property.



D2 Roof Coverings

The sloping roof is covered with concrete tiles over a secondary waterproof barrier.

1

The roof coverings are in acceptable condition. No major repairs are currently needed.

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

D3 Rainwater pipes and gutters

The rainwater pipes and gutters are plastic.

1

The rainwater pipes and gutters are currently in a serviceable condition and with no significant defects.

The rainwater gutters and pipes are shared with the neighbouring property. You should check with your legal adviser about your rights and obligations (see section H3).

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

D4 Main walls

The outside walls of the house are built of cavity construction (with an air gap between the inside and outside faces, called a cavity wall). The outer faces of the wall are brick-faced. Where visible,

2

the walls have a barrier against dampness rising from the ground (called a damp-proof course or DPC).

Ground levels are high in some positions and as a consequence plastic vents, which vent the sub floor, have been partially blocked by gravel. I removed some of the gravel to inspect them.

The weep holes above the patio doors have been filled with cement mortar which prevents them functioning as intended.

Otherwise, external surfaces are in acceptable condition with no serious defects apparent such as movement or dampness.

Condition Rating 2. The element has defects that need repairing or replacing, but are not considered to be either serious or urgent. This element must also be maintained in the normal way. You should follow the advice given in Section K - 'What to do now'.



Photo - 2 Blocked weep holes

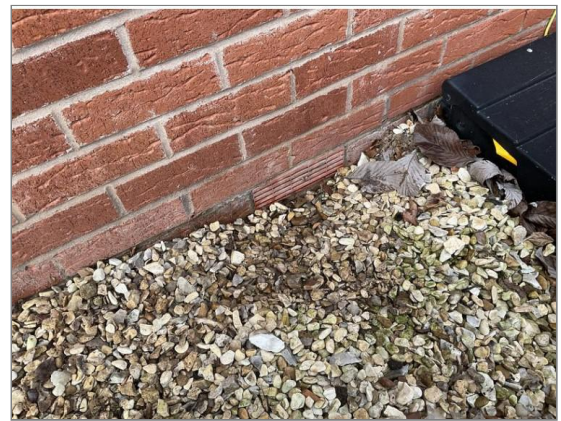


Photo - 3 High ground levels and partially blocked air vents.

D5 Windows

The windows in the property are double glazed and made of plastic (UPVC).

The seals around the outside of the frame on one of the rear windows is defective and peeling away from the brickwork.

The windows themselves are generally in satisfactory condition.

Condition Rating 2. The element has defects that need repairing or replacing, but are not considered to be either serious or urgent. This element must also be maintained in the normal way. You should follow the advice given in Section K - 'What to do now'.

2



Photo - 4 Mastic sealant peeling from around the frame.

D6 Outside doors (including patio doors)

At the front is a composite double glazed door in a plastic frame. At the rear there is a plastic patio door in a plastic frame. The doors are secured by multi-point locking mechanisms. The glazing in the doors is made from safety glass.

1

The doors are in satisfactory condition. No major repairs are currently needed.

Condition rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

D7 Conservatory and porches

There are no Conservatories or Porches at the property.



D8 Other joinery and finishes

The joinery around the property is formed in plastic. There is a canopy over the front door which has a plastic roof and frame.

1

The joinery is in satisfactory condition with no significant defects apparent. No repairs are currently needed.

Condition rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

D9 Other

There are no other elements that require comment.



E

Inside the property

E

Inside the property

Limitations on the inspection

Only a head and shoulders inspection of the roof space was undertaken.

Fitted floor coverings, items of furniture and storage restricted the inspection of the main areas and were not moved.

The underside of the staircase was enclosed and not visible.

Stored items within built in cupboards, wardrobes and kitchen units limited the inspection.

A random sample of fitted kitchen units and drawers were tested.

There may be hidden defects in the areas I could not inspect. The condition ratings assigned throughout this report are based on what was visible to me at the time of inspection.



E1 Roof structure

The roof space is entered through a hatch in the landing ceiling. There is a fixed ladder to aid access.

1

The roof structure is built of prefabricated timber roof trusses. The roof space has fibreglass quilt thermal insulation on top of the ceiling.

The roof space and structure are in a generally satisfactory condition.

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

E2 Ceilings

The ceilings are made of modern plasterboard fixed to timber ceiling joists.

1

The ceilings were secure and even and all surfaces are presented in fair decorative order.

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

E3 Walls and partitions

The internal walls and partitions are built of timber stud construction.

1

The walls and partitions are in satisfactory order. I found no evidence of significant dampness within the scope of my inspection.

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

E4 Floors

The ground floor is made of suspended concrete. The upper floor is made of timber.

1

The floors and coverings are in satisfactory condition with no obvious serious defects.

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

E5 Fireplaces, chimney breasts and flues

There are no fireplaces or chimney breasts at the property.



E6 Built-in fittings (built-in kitchen and other fittings, not including appliances)

There are a number of modern built-in fittings in the kitchen. There are fitted wardrobes in the front bedroom.

3

The mixer tap in the Kitchen was dripping during the inspection and the tap was loose from the sink.

The cooker hob plate is damaged on one corner of the hob, which has exposed a part of the work surface underneath. The damaged hob is a safety risk to persons (See Section I3).

There are flimsy mirrored sliding doors to the wardrobes in the front bedroom. There are no visible safety markings to the glazed doors. This is a potential safety hazard to persons (See section I3).

The kitchen units, doors are generally in satisfactory condition, subject to normal wear and tear.

Condition Rating 3. The element has defects that are serious and/or need to be repaired, replaced or investigated urgently. You should follow the advice given in Section K - 'What to do now'.



Photo - 5 No safety markings to glazed doors.



Photo - 6 Broken glass hob plate.



Photo - 7 Loose mixer tap

E7 Woodwork (for example, staircase joinery)

The internal woodwork includes such items such as doors, door frames, skirting, bannisters and staircases.

1

The woodwork is generally in satisfactory condition.

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

E8 Bathroom fittings

The bathroom and cloakroom have modern appliances and fittings.

1

The fittings are generally in satisfactory condition.

Condition rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

E9 Other

There are no other elements that require comment.



F

Services

Services are generally hidden within the construction of the property. This means that we can only inspect the visible parts of the available services, and we do not carry out specialist tests. The visual inspection cannot assess the services to make sure they work efficiently and safely, and meet modern standards.

F

Services

Limitations on the inspection

All services and associated fittings and constructions should be inspected and tested by the relevant contractor registered under a competent person scheme listed on the governments competent person scheme website.

The incoming water service pipe could not be seen and hence no comments can be made regarding its condition or suitability.

Only visible pipework could be inspected internally. The pipes concealed within the structure could not be inspected. Also, low-level pipework in the kitchen and bathroom is concealed and could not be inspected.

As the weather was dry at the time of the inspection, I am unable to comment fully on the effectiveness of the rainwater disposal system.

The surface water drains have not been tested and as most of the drainage system is hidden below ground its condition or effectiveness is not fully known.

Services such as: burglar, fire, smoke, and carbon monoxide alarms, TV, cable and internet connections are not tested.



F1 Electricity

Safety warning: The Electrical Safety Council recommends that you should get a registered electrician to check the property and its electrical fittings at least every ten years, or on change of occupancy. All electrical installation work undertaken after 1 January 2005 should have appropriate certification. For more advice, contact the Electrical Safety Council.

The meter for this supply is at the front of the property. Mains electricity is connected with the consumer unit located in the hallway.

3

The consumer unit is not in fire-rated housing as required by the current Building Regulation standards.

The light fitting in the bathroom is exposed and not IP rated (an enclosed fitting).

The electrical installation appears satisfactory with no obvious visual defects, but much is hidden from view. As such systems require specialist knowledge, I cannot comment on its serviceability or safety.

There is no recent (within the last 12 months) test certificate available for this electrical installation. This is a risk to the building and people and I refer you to my comments in section I. You should therefore obtain a precautionary circuit test from an NICEIC or similar registered electrician and follow their recommendations as to any upgrading/improvements required. Any works required should be carried out before use or occupation.

Your legal adviser should check the validity of any test certification for the installation. I refer you to my comments in Section H. Until the installation has been tested and certified as safe, it should not

be used.

Condition Rating 3. The element has defects that are serious and/or need to be repaired, replaced or investigated urgently. You should follow the advice given in Section K - 'What to do now'.



Photo - 8 Consumer unit



Photo - 9 Meter



Photo - 10 Bathroom light fitting.

F2 Gas/oil

Safety warning: All gas and oil appliances and equipment should be regularly inspected, tested, maintained and serviced by a registered 'competent person' in line with the manufacturer's instructions. This is important to make sure that the equipment is working correctly, to limit the risk of fire and carbon monoxide poisoning, and to prevent carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases from leaking into the air. For more advice, contact the Gas Safe Register for gas installations, and OFTEC for oil installations.

Mains gas is connected to this property with the meter/isolating valve located at the front of the property.

3

The installation appears in fair order with no significant defects evident. However, as much is hidden from view and as such systems require specialist knowledge, I am unable to advise on its serviceability or safety.

I have not seen evidence that the gas installation has been inspected or safety tested within the last 12 months. This is a risk to the building and people (see Section I).

The gas meter cupboard has debris in it which includes leaves and gravel.

Condition Rating 3. The element has defects that are serious and/or need to be repaired, replaced or investigated urgently. You should follow the advice given in Section K - 'What to do now'.



Photo - 11 Gas meter

F3 Water

Mains water is connected to this property.

1

The external stopcock and water meter are in the pavement in the street at the end of the row of properties to which this property belongs. There are three stopcock chambers close together and it is not clear which chamber belongs to which property. You should establish which of the stopcock chambers belongs to your property. The internal stopcock is kitchen under the sink.

Where visible the cold water installation is satisfactory with no serious defects or obvious leakage. Much of the pipework is concealed and it is, therefore, possible that defects could exist in unseen areas. I have not carried out any tests on the system and therefore I cannot comment on the operation or serviceability of any of its components.

Condition Rating 1. No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.

F4 Heating

Central heating and hot water are provided by a gas condensing combination boiler in the kitchen. This comprises a boiler/heating unit and a system of radiators.

3

No obvious defects were seen, but I have only carried out a visual inspection of the system and, therefore cannot comment in detail on its working condition.

Heating installations should be installed and serviced regularly (usually every year) by an appropriately qualified person who is registered under the government-approved 'competent person' scheme. I have not seen evidence that it has been inspected or safety tested within the last 12 months. This is a risk to the building and people (see Section I). You should ask your legal advisers to confirm if this is the case.

In the event that these appliances have been serviced within the last 12 months, you should ask your legal advisers to obtain copies of previous service documentation for your records together

with any remaining warranty, confirming that this warranty is transferable to you as the new owner.

Carbon Monoxide alarms should be installed in rooms which contain solid fuel or gas appliances.

Condition Rating 3. Further Investigation - The installations should be inspected and safety tested. You should follow the advice given in Section K - 'What to do now'.

F5 Water heating

Hot water is provided directly by the central heating boiler. As mentioned in F4 Heating, I am not aware of any current test certificate for the boiler. See advice in F4 Heating.

3

Condition Rating 3. Further Investigation - The installations should be inspected and safety tested. You should follow the advice given in Section K - 'What to do now'.

F6 Drainage

The below-ground drainage system is the means of carrying wastewater from the property to an acceptable disposal system, the public sewers (mains drainage). The property is assumed to be connected to the public sewer. Without extensive exposure work, I cannot confirm the type or layout of the underground drainage system.

NI

The inspection chamber for the underground drainage is located at the front of the property.

Due to the design of the property the above-ground waste pipes are concealed within the fabric of the building.

Following changes in the law in October 2011, Water Companies may well be responsible for some or all of the underground drainpipes. Your legal adviser should check this aspect and report to you on its consequences and I refer you to my recommendations in Section H.

Condition rating NI - Not inspected

F7 Common services

There are no common services.



G

**Grounds
(including shared areas for flats)**

G

Grounds (including shared areas for flats)

Limitations on the inspection

The grounds could only be viewed from accessible areas within the boundary and from accessible public areas.

The boundary fences could not be inspected in places due to vegetation.



G1 Garage

There are no garages.



G2 Permanent outbuildings and other structures

There are no outbuildings or permanent structures present or to report on.



G3 Other

You should ask your legal advisor to confirm your boundary responsibilities. Refer to my comments in section H.



A gate at the rear opens onto a shared pathway. You should ask your legal adviser to confirm the right of way which exist over this path (see Section H3).

There is a shared section of road to the front of the property which serves the properties within the terrace. You should ask your legal adviser to confirm its ownership and the rights of way which exist over it (see Section H3).

No evidence of the presence of Japanese Knotweed was seen during my inspection but you are advised to seek further advice if you believe it may be present or are aware that it is present in premises nearby.

H

Issues for your legal advisers

We do not act as a legal adviser and will not comment on any legal documents. However, if, during the inspection, we identify issues that your legal advisers may need to investigate further, we may refer to these in the report (for example, to state you should check whether there is a warranty covering replacement windows). You should show your legal advisers this section of the report.



Issues for your legal advisers

H1 Regulation

Ask your legal advisor to check whether Local Authority notifications, approvals and completion certificates have been obtained for the original construction.

H2 Guarantees

Ask your legal advisor to check for the existence, validity and transferability of enforceable guarantees and certificates for the 10-Year Builders Warranty for property - NHBC or similar which should be assigned to you as a new owner of the property.

Ask your legal advisor to establish in the pre-contract enquiries the existence and validity of any service agreements or engineer's certificates for the Electrical and Central heating system with this property.

H3 Other matters

The property is believed to be Freehold and your legal advisor should confirm this and explain the implications.

Your legal Advisor should seek to obtain information relating to the following matters:

- * Whether the roads and footpaths are adopted.
- * If there are any Estate Charges for the development and if so what are the annual payments and are they paid up to date..
- * Rights and responsibilities of service road accessing the property.
- * The rights of way which exist over the shared pathway to the rear of the terrace.
- * Ownership and obligations for the maintenance, extent and position of the property's boundaries and any reciprocal rights for neighbouring properties.
- * Your rights and liabilities for the drainage pipes that not only serve this property but which also serve neighbouring properties. If some of these drain pipes are now designated as Public Sewers under legislation passed in 2011 and are within your boundary, your right to build over these drains may be restricted.
- * Shared surface water drainage.



Risks

This section summarises defects and issues that present a risk to the building or grounds, or a safety risk to people. These may have been reported and condition-rated against more than one part of the property, or may be of a more general nature. They may have existed for some time and cannot be reasonably changed.

Risks

I1 Risks to the building

--

I2 Risks to the grounds

--

I3 Risks to people

--

I4 Other risks or hazards

--

J

Surveyor's declaration

J

Surveyor's declaration

Surveyor's RICS number**Qualifications****Company****Address****Phone number****Email****Website****Property address****Client's name****Date the report was produced**

I confirm that I have inspected the property and prepared this report.

Signature

K

What to do now

K

Further investigations and getting quotes

We have provided advice below on what to do next, now that you have an overview of any work to be carried out on the property. We recommend you make a note of any quotations you receive.

Getting quotations

The cost of repairs may influence the amount you are prepared to pay for the property. Before you make a legal commitment to buy the property, you should get reports and quotations for all the repairs and further investigations the surveyor may have identified. You should get at least two quotations from experienced contractors who are properly insured.

You should also:

- ask them for references from people they have worked for;
- describe in writing exactly what you will want them to do; and
- get the contractors to put their quotations in writing.

Some repairs will need contractors who have specialist skills and who are members of regulated organisations (for example, electricians, gas engineers, plumbers and so on). You may also need to get Building Regulations permission or planning permission from your local authority for some work.

Further investigations and what they involve

If we are concerned about the condition of a hidden part of the building, could only see part of a defect or do not have the specialist knowledge to assess part of the property fully, we may have recommended that further investigations should be carried out to discover the true extent of the problem.

This will depend on the type of problem, but to do this properly, parts of the home may have to be disturbed, so you should discuss this matter with the current owner. In some cases, the cost of investigation may be high.

When a further investigation is recommended, the following will be included in your report:

- a description of the affected element and why a further investigation is required
- when a further investigation should be carried out and
- a broad indication of who should carry out the further investigation.

Who you should use for further investigations

You should ask an appropriately qualified person, although it is not possible to tell you which one. Specialists belonging to different types of organisations will be able to do this. For example, qualified electricians can belong to five different government-approved schemes. If you want further advice, please contact the surveyor.



Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 1 service and terms of engagement

Description of the RICS Home Survey – Level 1 service and terms of engagement

The service

The RICS Home Survey – Level 1 service includes:

- a physical **inspection** of the property (see 'The inspection' below)
- a **report** based on the inspection (see 'The report' below) and

The surveyor who provides the RICS Home Survey – Level 1 service aims to:

- describe the part or element in enough detail so that it can be properly identified
- provide a clear and concise expression of the surveyor's professional assessment of each part or element
- describe the condition of the part or element that justifies the surveyor's assessment and
- help you gain an objective view of the condition of the property.

Any extra services provided that are not covered by the terms and conditions of this service must be covered by a separate contract.

The inspection

The surveyor inspects the inside and outside of the main building and all permanent outbuildings, recording the construction and significant visible defects that are evident. This inspection is intended to cover as much of the property as is physically accessible. Where this is not possible, an explanation is provided in the 'Limitations on the inspection' box in the relevant section of the report.

The surveyor does not force or open up the fabric of the building. This includes taking up fitted carpets, fitted floor coverings or floorboards; moving heavy furniture; removing the contents of cupboards, roof spaces; removing secured panels and/or hatches; or undoing electrical fittings.

The surveyor will not remove secured access panels and/or lift insulation material, stored goods or other contents. The surveyor will visually inspect the parts of the roof structure and other features that can be seen from the access hatch.

If necessary, the surveyor carries out parts of the inspection when standing at ground level, from adjoining public property where accessible. This means the extent of the inspection will depend on a range of individual circumstances at the time of inspection, and the surveyor judges each case on an individual basis.

The surveyor uses equipment such as a damp meter, binoculars and torch, and uses a ladder for flat roofs and for hatches no more than 3m above level ground (outside) or floor surfaces (inside) if it is safe to do so.

The surveyor also carries out a desk-top study and makes oral enquiries for information about matters affecting the property.

Services to the property

Services are generally hidden within the construction of the property. This means that only the visible parts of the available services can be inspected, and the surveyor does not carry out specialist tests. The visual inspection cannot assess the efficiency or safety of electrical, gas or other energy sources. It also does not investigate the plumbing, heating or drainage installations (or whether they meet current regulations); or the internal condition of any chimney, boiler or other flue.

Outside the property

The surveyor inspects the condition of boundary walls, fences, permanent outbuildings and areas in common (shared) use. To inspect these areas, the surveyor walks around the grounds and any neighbouring public property where access can be obtained. Where there are restrictions to access (e.g. a creeper plant prevents closer inspection), these are reported and advice is given on any potential underlying risks that may require further investigation.

Buildings with swimming pools and sports facilities are also treated as permanent outbuildings and are therefore inspected, but the surveyor does not report on the leisure facilities, such as the pool itself and its equipment internally or externally, landscaping and other facilities (for example, tennis courts and temporary outbuildings).

Flats

When inspecting flats, the surveyor assesses the general condition of the outside surfaces of the building, as well as its access areas (for example, shared hallways and staircases that lead directly to the subject flat) and roof spaces, but only if they are accessible from within and owned by the subject flat. The surveyor does not inspect drains, lifts, fire alarms and security systems.

External wall systems are not inspected. If the surveyor has specific concerns about these items, further investigation will be recommended before making a legal commitment to purchase.

Dangerous materials, contamination and environmental issues

The surveyor does not make any enquiries about contamination or other environmental dangers. If the surveyor suspects a problem, they should recommend further investigation.

The surveyor may assume that no harmful or dangerous materials have been used in the construction, and does not have a duty to justify making this assumption. However, if the inspection shows that such materials have been used, the surveyor must report this and ask for further instructions.

The surveyor does not carry out an asbestos inspection and does not act as an asbestos inspector when inspecting properties that may fall within The Control of Asbestos Regulations 2012 ('CAR 2012'). However, the report should properly emphasise the suspected presence of asbestos containing materials if the inspection identifies that possibility. With flats, the surveyor assumes that there is a 'dutyholder' (as defined in CAR 2012), and that there is an asbestos register and an effective management plan in place, which does not present a significant risk to health or need any immediate payment. The surveyor does not consult the dutyholder.

The report

The surveyor produces a report of the inspection results for you to use, but cannot accept any liability if it is used by anyone else. If you decide not to act on the advice in the report, you do this at your own risk. The report is aimed at providing you with an understanding of the condition of the property to allow you to make an informed decision on serious or urgent repairs, and on the maintenance of the issues reported.

The RICS Home Survey – Level 1 report does not include advice on repairs or ongoing maintenance issues.

Where the surveyor is unable to reach a conclusion with reasonable confidence, a recommendation for further investigation should be made.

Condition ratings

The surveyor gives condition ratings to the main parts (the ‘elements’) of the main building, garage and some outside elements. The condition ratings are described as follows:

- **R** – Documents we may suggest you request before you sign contracts.
- **Condition rating 3** – Defects that are serious and/or need to be repaired, replaced or investigated urgently. Failure to do so could risk serious safety issues or severe long-term damage to your property. Written quotations for repairs should be obtained prior to legal commitment to purchase.
- **Condition rating 2** – Defects that need repairing or replacing but are not considered to be either serious or urgent. The property must be maintained in the normal way.
- **Condition rating 1** – No repair is currently needed. The property must be maintained in the normal way.
- **NI** – Elements not inspected.

The surveyor notes in the report if it was not possible to check any parts of the property that the inspection would normally cover. If the surveyor is concerned about these parts, the report tells you about any further investigations that are needed.

Energy

The surveyor has not prepared the Energy Performance Certificate (EPC) as part of the RICS Home Survey – Level 1 service for the property. Where the EPC has not been made available by others, the most recent certificate will be obtained from the appropriate central registry where practicable. If the surveyor has seen the current EPC, they will review and state the relevant energy efficiency rating in this report.

Issues for legal advisers

The surveyor does not act as a legal adviser and does not comment on any legal documents. If, during the inspection, the surveyor identifies issues that your legal advisers may need to investigate further, the surveyor may refer to these in the report (for example, to state you should check whether there is a warranty covering replacement windows).

This report has been prepared by a surveyor merely in their capacity as an employee or agent of a firm, company or other business entity ('the Company'). The report is the product of the Company, not of the individual surveyor. All of the statements and opinions contained in this report are expressed entirely on behalf of the Company, which accepts sole responsibility for them. For their part, the individual surveyor assumes no personal financial responsibility or liability in respect of the report, and no reliance or inference to the contrary should be drawn.

In the case of sole practitioners, the surveyor may sign the report in their own name, unless the surveyor operates as a sole trader limited liability company.

Nothing in this report excludes or limits liability for death or personal injury (including disease and impairment of mental condition) resulting from negligence.

Risks

This section summarises defects and issues that present a risk to the building or grounds, or a safety risk to people. These may have been reported and condition rated against more than one part of the property, or may be of a more general nature. They may have existed for some time and cannot be reasonably changed. The RICS Home Survey – Level 1 report will identify and list the risks, but give no further explanation.

Note: The Home Survey – Level 1 service does not include an opinion on either the market value of the property or the reinstatement cost.

Standard terms of engagement

1 The service – The surveyor provides the standard RICS Home Survey – Level 1 service described in this section, unless you agree with the surveyor in writing before the inspection that the surveyor will provide extra services. Any extra service will require separate terms of engagement to be entered into with the surveyor. Examples of extra services include:

- costing of repairs
- schedules of works
- supervision of works
- re-inspection
- detailed specific issue reports and
- market valuation and reinstatement costs

2 The surveyor – The service will be provided by an AssocRICS, MRICS or FRICS member of the Royal Institution of Chartered Surveyors (RICS) who has the skills, knowledge and experience to survey and report on the property.

3 Before the inspection – Before the inspection, you should tell us if there is already an agreed or proposed price for the property, and if you have any particular concerns about the property (such as a crack noted above the bathroom window or any plans for extension).

4 Terms of payment – You agree to pay the surveyor's fee and any other charges agreed in writing.

5 Cancelling this contract – You should seek advice on your obligations under The Consumer Contracts (Information, Cancellation and Additional Charges) Regulations 2013 ('the Regulations') and/or the Consumer Rights Act 2015, in accordance with section 2.6 of the current edition of the Home survey standard RICS professional statement.

6 Liability – The report is provided for your use, and the surveyor cannot accept responsibility if it is used, or relied upon, by anyone else.

Note: These terms form part of the contract between you and the surveyor.

This report is for use in the UK.

Complaints handling procedure

The surveyor will have a complaints handling procedure and will give you a copy if you ask for it. The surveyor is required to provide you with contact details, in writing, for their complaints department or the person responsible for dealing with client complaints. Where the surveyor is party to a redress scheme, those details should also be provided. If any of this information is not provided, please notify the surveyor and ask for it to be supplied.

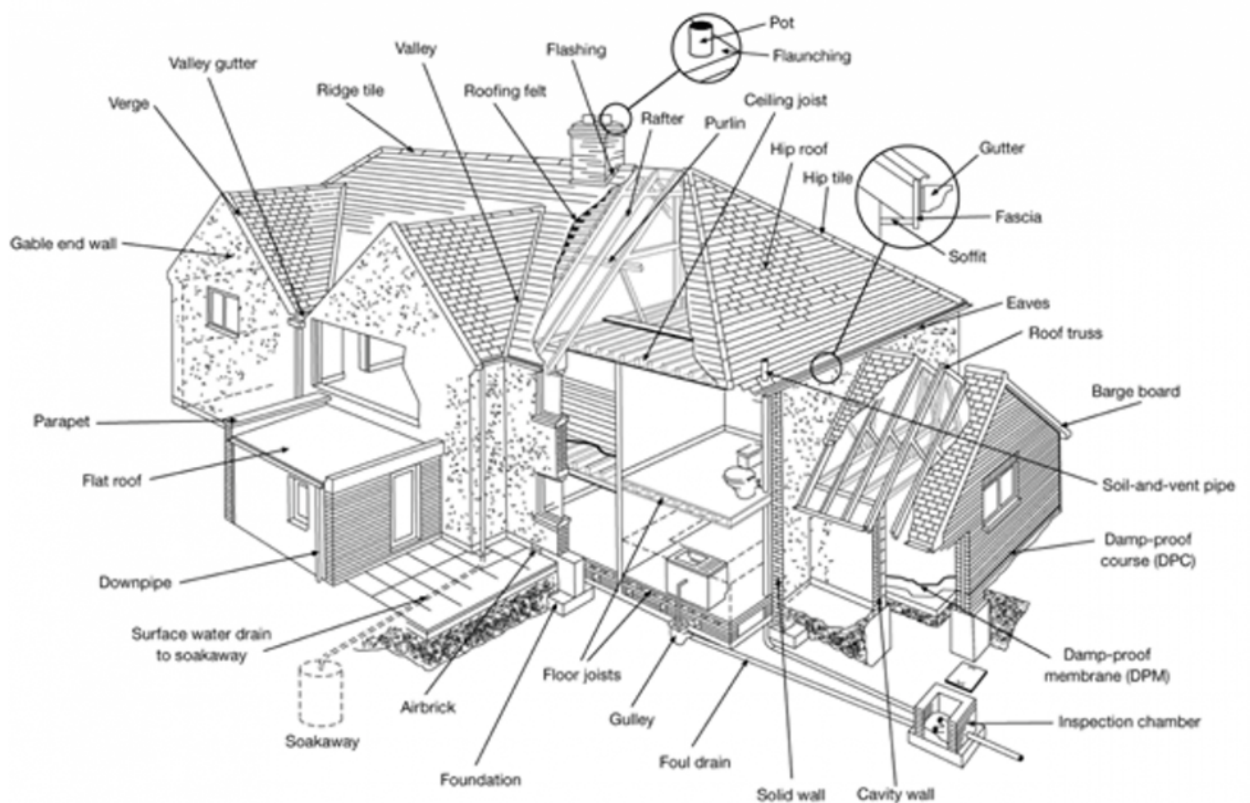
M

Typical house diagram

M

Typical house diagram

This diagram illustrates where you may find some of the building elements referred to in the report.



RICS disclaimer

You should know...

This report has been prepared by a surveyor merely in their capacity as an employee or agent of a firm, company or other business entity ('the Company'). The report is the product of the Company, not of the individual surveyor. All of the statements and opinions contained in this report are expressed entirely on behalf of the Company, which accepts sole responsibility for them. For their part, the individual surveyor assumes no personal financial responsibility or liability in respect of the report, and no reliance or inference to the contrary should be drawn.

In the case of sole practitioners, the surveyor may sign the report in their own name, unless the surveyor operates as a sole trader limited liability company.

Nothing in this report excludes or limits liability for death or personal injury (including disease and impairment of mental condition) resulting from negligence.

This document is issued in blank form by the Royal Institution of Chartered Surveyors (RICS) and is available only to parties who have signed a licence agreement with RICS.

RICS gives no representations or warranties, express or implied, and no responsibility or liability is accepted for the accuracy or completeness of the information inserted into the document, or any other written or oral information given to any interested party or its advisers. Any such liability is expressly disclaimed.